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Mu estimation modeled by tie rod loads

Abstract

Examples provide a system and method for controlling a vehicle or a fleet of vehicles. The system includes a set of vehicle sensors configured to measure a speed of the vehicle and a motor torque. The system also includes an electronic processor configured to determine a modeled rack force of the vehicle, determine a normal force factor of the vehicle, determine a vehicle speed factor of the vehicle, determine an adjusted rack force based on a product of the modeled rack force, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor, determine a lateral slip angle of the vehicle, and determine a coefficient of friction estimation based on the adjusted rack force and the lateral slip angle. The electronic processor is further configured to control the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) Embodiments, examples, and aspects described herein relate to, among other things, a system and method for vehicle control based on coefficient of friction estimation.

SUMMARY

(2) Control strategies for a vehicle may vary based on the friction of the surface that the vehicle or vehicles are driving on. The effectiveness of the control strategy is, in part, dependent on the time a processor in a vehicle takes to estimate a coefficient of friction for the surface. Therefore, there is a need to improve calculation of the coefficient of friction. Aspects disclosed herein provide, among other things, systems and methods for estimating the coefficient of friction for a driving surface of a vehicle or a fleet of vehicles, and controlling the vehicle based on the estimation.

(3) One example provides a system for controlling a vehicle. The system includes a set of vehicle sensors configured to measure a speed of the vehicle and output a measured vehicle speed, and measure a motor torque of a motor in the vehicle and output a measured motor torque. The system also includes an electronic processor configured to determine a modeled rack force of the vehicle, determine a normal force factor of the vehicle, determine a vehicle speed factor of the vehicle, determine an adjusted rack force based on a product of the modeled rack force, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor, determine a lateral slip angle of the vehicle, determine a coefficient of friction estimation based on the adjusted rack force and the lateral slip angle, and control the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

(4) In some aspects, the electronic processor is configured to determine the modeled rack force by determining a gear ratio of a motor in the vehicle, determining an inertia of a rotor of the motor, determining an acceleration of the rotor, determining a motor torque of the motor, determining a torsion bar torque of a torsion bar, determining a torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, and determining a friction torque of the motor.

(5) In some aspects, the electronic processor is further configured to determine the modeled rack force by determining a first product of the inertia of the rotor and the acceleration of the rotor, determining a second product of the torsion bar torque and torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, determining a first sum of the motor torque, the second product, and the friction torque, determining a first difference between the first product and the first sum, and determining a third product of the gear ratio and the first difference.

(6) In some aspects, the electronic processor is configured to determine the coefficient of friction estimation using a look-up table (LUT).

(7) In some aspects, the electronic processor is further configured to determine a type of driving surface of the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

(8) In some aspects, the electronic processor is configured to determine whether the type of driving surface is at least one selected from the group consisting of ice, snow, gravel, wet paved road, and dry paved road.

(9) In some aspects, the system includes a user interface, wherein the electronic processor is further configured to provide, to the user interface, an indication of the type of driving surface.

(10) In some aspects, the electronic processor is configured to control the vehicle by determining an optimal lateral slip for an upcoming turn, determining a target vehicle speed for achieving the

optimal lateral slip, and controlling the vehicle according to the target vehicle speed.

(11) In some aspects, the electronic processor is further configured to transmit the coefficient of friction estimation to an autonomous vehicle fleet controller for controlling speeds of a fleet of autonomous vehicles.

(12) Another example provides a method for controlling a vehicle. The method includes measuring, with a set of vehicle sensors, a speed of the vehicle, outputting a measured vehicle speed a motor torque of a motor in the vehicle, and outputting a measured motor torque. The method also includes determining, with an electronic processor, a modeled rack force of the vehicle, determining a normal force factor of the vehicle, determining a vehicle speed factor of the vehicle, determining an adjusted rack force based on a product of the modeled rack force, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor, determining a lateral slip angle of the vehicle, determining a coefficient of friction estimation based on the adjusted rack force and the lateral slip angle, and controlling the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

(13) In some aspects, determining the modeled rack force includes determining a gear ratio of a motor in the vehicle, determining an inertia of a rotor of the motor, determining an acceleration of the rotor, determining a motor torque of the motor, determining a torsion bar torque of a torsion bar, determining a torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, and determining a friction torque of the motor.

(14) In some aspects, determining the modeled rack force further includes determining a first product of the inertia of the rotor and the acceleration of the rotor, determining a second product of the torsion bar torque and torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, determining a first sum of the motor torque, the second product, and the friction torque, determining a first difference between the first product and the first sum, and determining a third product of the gear ratio and the first difference.

(15) In some aspects the coefficient of friction estimation includes using a look-up table (LUT).

(16) In some aspects, the method includes determining, with the electronic processor, a type of driving surface of the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

(17) In some aspects, determining the type of driving surface of the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation includes determining whether the type of driving surface is at least one selected from the group consisting of ice, snow, gravel, wet paved road, and dry paved road.

(18) In some aspects, the method includes providing, with the electronic processor, an indication to a user interface, the indication indicative of the type of driving surface.

(19) In some aspects, controlling the vehicle includes determining an optimal lateral slip for an upcoming turn, determining a target vehicle speed for achieving the optimal lateral slip, and controlling the vehicle according to the target vehicle speed.

(20) In some aspects, the method includes transmitting, with the electronic processor, the coefficient of friction estimation to an autonomous vehicle fleet controller for controlling speeds of a fleet of autonomous vehicles.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates a vehicle, according to some aspects.

(2) FIG. 2 illustrates an electronic controller for a vehicle, according to some aspects.

(3) FIG. 3 illustrates a method for estimating a coefficient of friction, according to some aspects.

(4) FIG. 4 illustrates a comparison of lateral slip to rack force, according to some aspects.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(5) Before any aspects, features, or instances are explained in detail, it is to be understood that the aspects, features, or instances are not limited in their application to the details of construction and

the arrangement of components set forth in the following description or illustrated in the following drawings. Other instances are possible and are capable of being practiced or of being carried out in various ways.

(6) Also, it is to be understood that the phraseology and terminology used herein is for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting. The terms “mounted,” “connected” and “coupled” are used broadly and encompass both direct and indirect mounting, connecting, and coupling. Further, “connected” and “coupled” are not restricted to physical or mechanical connections or couplings, and can include electrical connections or couplings, whether direct or indirect. Also, electronic communications and notifications may be performed using any known means including wired connections, wireless connections, etc.

(7) It should also be noted that a plurality of hardware and software based devices, as well as a plurality of different structural components may be utilized in various implementations. Aspects, features, and instances may include hardware, software, and electronic components or modules that, for purposes of discussion, may be illustrated and described as if the majority of the components were implemented solely in hardware. However, one of ordinary skill in the art, and based on a reading of this detailed description, would recognize that, in at least one instance, the electronic based aspects of the invention may be implemented in software (for example, stored on non-transitory computer-readable medium) executable by one or more processors. As a consequence, it should be noted that a plurality of hardware and software based devices, as well as a plurality of different structural components may be utilized to implement the invention. For example, “control units” and “controllers” described in the specification can include one or more electronic processors, one or more memory modules including a non-transitory computer-readable medium, one or more input/output interfaces, and various connections (for example, a system bus) connecting the components. It should be understood that although certain drawings illustrate hardware and software located within particular devices, these depictions are for illustrative purposes only. In some instances, the illustrated components may be combined or divided into separate software, firmware and/or hardware. For example, instead of being located within and performed by a single electronic processor, logic and processing may be distributed among multiple electronic processors. Regardless of how they are combined or divided, hardware and software components may be located on the same computing device or may be distributed among different computing devices connected by one or more networks or other suitable communication links.

(8) For ease of description, some or all of the example systems presented herein are illustrated with a single exemplar of each of its component parts. Some examples may not describe or illustrate all components of the systems. Other instances may include more or fewer of each of the illustrated components, may combine some components, or may include additional or alternative components.

(9) Lateral slip angle, otherwise referred to herein as “side slip” or “slip angle,” is the angle between the direction in which a vehicle's wheel is pointing and the direction in which the steered axle is actually traveling. The lateral slip angle results in a lateral force perpendicular to the longitudinal wheel axis of the vehicle. The lateral force increases approximately linearly for the first few degrees of slip angle, then increases non-linearly to a maximum before beginning to decrease. The lateral force, determined based on lateral acceleration, and the slip angle are historically used to estimate the coefficient of friction of the surface on which a vehicle is driving. The coefficient of friction may alternatively be referred to herein as “surface mu.” A vehicle controller may use surface mu as an input to a vehicle control strategy such as, for example, anti-lock braking systems (ABS), traction control systems (TCS), vehicle speed control, and other vehicle control systems. A vehicle controller may also use surface mu as an input to an autonomous vehicle fleet control strategy, for example, to slow down traffic on surfaces having low mu due to ice, snow, oil, or hydroplaning. For example, surface mu data may be transmitted from a vehicle to a mu map accessible to other connected vehicles.

(10) FIG. 1 schematically illustrates a vehicle **10**, according to some aspects. In some instances, the vehicle **10** is an autonomous vehicle. The term “autonomous vehicle” is used in an inclusive way to refer to an autonomous or partially autonomous vehicle, which possesses varying degrees of automation (that is, the vehicle is configured to drive itself with limited, or in some cases no, input from a driver). The term “driver,” as used herein, generally refers to an occupant of a vehicle, who operates the controls of the vehicle or provides control input to the vehicle to influence the operation of the vehicle. However, in some instances, the vehicle **10** is not an autonomous vehicle. In some instances, vehicle **10** represents one of many vehicles in a fleet.

(11) In the illustrated example, the vehicle **10** includes an electronic controller **14**, vehicle control systems **18**, a motor **20**, a plurality of sensors **22** installed on the vehicle **10**, a steering rack **24** for steering a front and/or rear axle of the vehicle **10**, and a user interface **26**. The components of the vehicle **10**, along with other various modules and components are electrically and communicatively coupled to each other via direct connections or by or through one or more control or data buses (for example, the bus **30**), which enable communication therebetween. The use of control and data buses for the interconnection between, and communication among, the various modules and components would be known to a person skilled in the art in view of the invention described herein. In some instances, the bus **30** is a controller area network (CAN) bus. In some instances, the bus **30** is an automotive Ethernet, a FlexRay™ communications bus, or another suitable bus. In some instances, some or all of the components of the vehicle **10** may be communicatively coupled using suitable wireless modalities (for example, Bluetooth™ or near field communication connections).

(12) The electronic controller **14** (described in greater detail below with respect to FIG. 2) communicates with vehicle control systems **18** and the sensors **22**. The electronic controller **14** may receive sensor data from the sensors **22** and determine control commands for the vehicle **10**. The electronic controller **14** transmits the control commands to, among other things, the vehicle control systems **18** to operate or assist in operating the vehicle **10** (for example, by generating braking signals, acceleration signals, steering signals). In some instances, the electronic controller **14** is part of one or more vehicle controllers that implement autonomous or partially autonomous control of the vehicle **10**. The electronic controller **14** may be located in a suitable location or locations in the vehicle **10**. For example, the electronic controller **14** may be located between the bus **30** and the steering rack **24**.

(13) The vehicle control systems **18** may include controllers, actuators, and the like for controlling aspects of the operation of the vehicle **10** (for example, acceleration, braking, shifting gears, and the like). The vehicle control systems **18** communicate with the electronic controller **14** via the bus **30**.

(14) The sensors **22** measure one or more attributes of the vehicle **10** and the environment around the vehicle **10** and communicate information regarding those attributes to the other components of the vehicle **10** using, for example, messages transmitted on the bus **30**. The sensors **22** may include, for example, sensors that detect accelerator pedal position and brake pedal position, wheel speed sensors, steering angle sensors, vehicle speed sensors, yaw, pitch, and roll sensors, Hall effect sensors, force sensors, torque sensors, rotor position sensors, and vehicle proximity sensors (for example, ultrasonic). In some instances, the sensors **22** are similar to sensor sets used in an electronic stability control (ESC) system and similar vehicle control systems.

(15) In some instances, the electronic controller **14** controls aspects of the vehicle **10** based on commands received from the user interface **26**. The user interface **26** provides an interface between the components of the vehicle **10** and an occupant (for example, a driver) of the vehicle **10**. The user interface **26** is configured to receive input from the driver, receive indications of vehicle status from the system's controllers (for example, the electronic controller **14**), and provide information to the driver based on the received indications. The user interface **26** provides visual output, such as, for example, graphical indicators (for example, fixed or animated icons), lights, colors, text,

images, combinations of the foregoing, and the like. The user interface **26** includes a suitable display mechanism for displaying the visual output, such as, for example, a liquid crystal display (LCD) touch screen, or an organic light-emitting diode (OLED) touch screen), or other suitable mechanisms. In some instances, the user interface **26** displays a graphical user interface (GUI) (for example, generated by the electronic controller **14** and presented on a display screen) that enables a driver or passenger to interact with the vehicle **10**. The user interface **26** may also provide audio output to the driver via a chime, buzzer, speaker, or other suitable device included in the user interface **26** or separate from the user interface **26**. In some instances, user interface **26** provides haptic outputs to the driver by vibrating one or more vehicle components (for example, the vehicle's steering wheel and the seats), for example, using a vibration motor. In some instances, user interface **26** provides a combination of visual, audio, and haptic outputs.

(16) FIG. 2 illustrates an example of the electronic controller **14**, which includes an electronic processor **34** (for example, a microprocessor, application specific integrated circuit, etc.), a memory **36**, and an input/output interface **38**. The memory **36** may be made up of one or more non-transitory computer-readable media and includes at least a program storage area and a data storage area. The program storage area and the data storage area can include combinations of different types of memory, such as read-only memory ("ROM"), random access memory ("RAM"), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory ("EEPROM"), flash memory, or other suitable memory devices. The electronic processor **34** is coupled to the memory **36** and the input/output interface **38**. The electronic processor **34** sends and receives information (for example, from the memory **36** and/or the input/output interface **38**) and processes the information by executing one or more software instructions or modules, capable of being stored in the memory **36**, or another non-transitory computer readable medium. The software can include firmware, one or more applications, program data, filters, rules, one or more program modules, and other executable instructions. The electronic processor **34** is configured to retrieve from the memory **36** and execute, among other things, software for performing methods as described herein. In the example illustrated, the memory **36** stores, among other things a rack force model **42** including a rack force model look-up table (LUT) for storing a model of vehicle rack force values, lateral slip angle values, and vehicle speeds used in estimating surface μ . The input/output interface **38** transmits and receives information from devices external to the electronic controller **14** (for example, components of the vehicle **10** via the bus **30**). It should be understood that the electronic controller **14** may include additional components than those illustrated in FIG. 2 and in various configurations. For example, in some examples, the electronic controller **14** includes multiple electronic processors **34**, multiple memory modules **36**, multiple input/output interfaces **38**, or a combination thereof.

(17) FIG. 3 illustrates an example method **50** executable by the electronic processor **34** for estimating surface μ , according to some aspects. Rather than estimating surface μ based on lateral acceleration, which may require a sufficiently large acceleration value (e.g., 3 meters per second squared (m/s^2)) in order to accurately estimate surface, the electronic processor **34** estimates surface μ based, in part, on the rack force of the steering rack **24** (e.g., based tie rod loads). Therefore, the electronic processor **34** may estimate surface μ faster and at lower lateral acceleration values (e.g., at 1 m/s^2), and, as a result, generate a control signal for the vehicle **10** sooner.

(18) At block **54**, the electronic processor **34** determines a modeled rack force $F_{\text{sub.rack}_m}$ by determining a gear ratio of the motor **20**, an inertia of a rotor included in the motor **20**, an acceleration of the rotor, a motor torque of the motor **20**, a torsion bar torque of a torsion bar in the vehicle **10**, a ratio of the torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio and/or a friction torque of the motor **20**. In one example, the electronic processor **34** calculates or determines a first product of the inertia of the rotor and the acceleration of the rotor. The electronic processor **34** determines a second product of the torsion bar torque and the ratio of the torsion bar torque to motor torque. The

electronic processor **34** then determines a first sum of the motor torque, the second product, and the friction torque. The electronic processor **34** determines a first difference between the first product and the first sum. The electronic processor **34** determines a third product of the gear ratio and the first difference.

(19) In one example, the electronic processor **34** determines the modeled rack force $F_{\text{sub.rack_m}}$ according to Equation 1, below:

$$(20) \quad F_{\text{rack_m}} = i_{\text{servo}} \times [J \times \overset{\text{Math.}}{\ddot{\varphi}} - (M_{\text{mot}} + M_{\text{TB}} \times i + M_{\text{fric}})] \quad \text{Equation 1}$$

(21) Where $i_{\text{sub.servo}}$ is the gear ratio of the motor **20**, J is the inertia of the rotor, $\{\ddot{\varphi}\}$ is the acceleration of the rotor, $M_{\text{sub.mot}}$ is the motor torque, $M_{\text{sub.TB}}$ is the torsion bar torque, i is the ratio of the of the torsion bar torque to motor torque, and $M_{\text{sub.fric}}$ is the friction that resists the lateral movement of the steering gear of the vehicle **10**.

(22) At block **58**, the electronic processor **34** determines a normal force factor for the vehicle **10** (e.g., a normal force on the steered axle of the vehicle) due to the bank angle of the vehicle **10**. For example, the electronic processor **34** determines the normal force factor based on a front axle normal force of the vehicle **10**. For example, the electronic processor **34** determines a front axle normal force based on a summation of the normal force on the front left wheel of the vehicle **10** and the normal force on the front right wheel of the vehicle **10**. The electronic processor **34** determines the normal force on the front left wheel of the vehicle **10** based, in part, on a vertical force distribution for the front left wheel in a lateral direction. The electronic processor **34** determines the vertical force distribution derived from the longitudinal and lateral acceleration of the vehicle **10**. For example, the vertical force distribution is adjusted based on slope, bank angle, center of gravity, height, trackwidth, wheelbase, and/or mass of the vehicle **10**.

(23) In some instances, the electronic processor **34** determines the normal force on the rear axle of the vehicle **10** (e.g., when the vehicle **10** is a rear-steer vehicle). For example, the electronic processor **34** determines a rear axle normal force based on a summation of the normal force on the rear left wheel of the vehicle **10** and the normal force on the rear right wheel of the vehicle **10**. With respect to the rear axle, the electronic processor **34** determines the vertical force distribution derived from the longitudinal and lateral acceleration of the vehicle **10**, which is adjusted for slope, bank angle, center of gravity, height, trackwidth, wheelbase, and mass of the vehicle **10**.

(24) The electronic processor **34** then determines the normal force factor according to, for example, the values in Table 1.

(25) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Normal Force Factor

Steered	2500	2750	3000	3250	3500	3750	4000	4250	4500	Axle Normal Force (Lbs)
0.9	0.95	1	1.05	1.1	1.15	1.2	1.25	1.3		

(26) At block **62**, the electronic processor **34** determines a vehicle speed factor for the vehicle **10**. The electronic processor **34** determines the vehicle speed factor based on the vehicle speed measured by the sensors **22**. The electronic processor **34** determines the vehicle speed factor according to, for example, the values in Table 2.

(27) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Vehicle Speed Factor

Vehicle Speed (kph)	0	2	5	10	40	80	120	160	200
3	2	1	0.8	0.7	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6

(28) At block **66**, after determining the modeled rack force $F_{\text{sub.rack_m}}$, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor, the electronic processor **34** determines an adjusted rack force as a product of the modelled rack force $F_{\text{sub.rack_m}}$, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor. The adjusted rack force accounts for the dynamic normal force on the axle and the speed of the vehicle.

(29) At block **72**, the electronic processor **34** determines the lateral slip for the vehicle **10**. The electronic processor **34** may determine lateral slip according to known methods, for example, based on the speed of the vehicle **10**, the steering angle of the vehicle **10**, the distance between the front axle and the center of mass of the vehicle **10**, and the measured yaw rate of the vehicle **10**.

(30) At block **76**, the electronic processor **34** inputs the adjusted rack force and the lateral slip into

the rack force model LUT. The rack force model **42** stores, for each of a plurality of various vehicle speeds, rack force values required to turn the steered axle tires and build lateral slip (e.g., the lateral slip as requested by the driver turning the steering wheel, and/or as requested by a vehicle controller). The rack force model **42** is periodically updated by the electronic processor **34** as the vehicle **10** travels, for example, every millisecond, every five milliseconds, every ten milliseconds, etc.

(31) As an example, FIG. **4** illustrates a mu estimation graph comparing lateral slip at the x-axis to adjusted rack force at the y-axis for four different surface types. As illustrated in FIG. **4**, ice generally requires less rack force to build a lateral slip angle compared to dry tarmac, wet tarmac, and snow. Snow generally requires less rack force to build a lateral slip angle compared to wet tarmac and dry tarmac. Wet tarmac generally requires less rack force to build a lateral slip angle compared to dry tarmac. While four types of surface estimations are described with respect to FIG. **4**, it should be understood that the rack force model **42** may store surface mu data for more than four surface types or less than four surface types.

(32) Referring again to FIG. **3**, at block **80**, the electronic processor **34** computes, based on the rack force model LUT, a surface mu estimation. In some instances, the electronic processor **34** estimates, based on the output of the rack force model LUT, a type of driving surface of the vehicle **10**. For example, the electronic processor **34** may estimate that the vehicle **10** is driving on at least one selected from the group consisting of dry paved road (e.g., dry tarmac, dry asphalt, dry concrete, etc.), wet paved road (e.g., wet tarmac, wet asphalt, wet concrete, etc.), a dirt road, a gravel road, snow, and ice.

(33) At block **84**, based on the surface mu estimation output by the rack force model LUT, the electronic processor **34** controls the vehicle **10**. For example, based on the output surface mu estimation, the electronic processor **34** identifies low-mu surfaces on the road, and lowers the speed of the vehicle **10**. For example, the electronic processor **34** may determine a target vehicle speed based on the surface mu estimation, and control the vehicle motor **20** based on the target vehicle speed. In some instances, the electronic processor **34** provides a recommendation to the user via the user interface **26** regarding the target vehicle speed.

(34) In some instances, the electronic processor **34** controls the vehicle **10** to initiate turns sooner on low-mu surfaces. For example, the electronic processor **34** may determine an optimal lateral slip for an upcoming turn. Based on the optimal lateral slip, the electronic processor **34** may determine one or both of a target vehicle speed to achieve the upcoming turn and a target position to initiate the turn.

(35) In some instances, the electronic processor **34** controls the vehicle **10** to change lanes such that the vehicle **10** drives on a higher-mu surface.

(36) In some instances, the electronic processor **34** provides an indication to the user interface **26** based on the surface mu estimation. For example, the electronic processor **34** may provide an indication of the type of driving surface of the vehicle **10**, an indication of road slipperiness, and/or a recommendation for a driving maneuver (e.g., changing lanes, reducing speed, etc.).

(37) The electronic processor **34** repeatedly performs the steps of the method **50**. For example, the electronic processor **34** may iterate through the steps of the method **50** every millisecond, every five milliseconds, every ten milliseconds, or another iteration period.

(38) Thus, aspects herein provide, among other things, systems and methods for mu estimation for a vehicle modeled by tie rod loads.

Claims

1. A system for controlling a vehicle, the system comprising: a set of vehicle sensors, the set of vehicle sensors configured to: measure a speed of the vehicle and output a measured vehicle speed, measure a motor torque of a motor in the vehicle and output a measured motor torque, electronic

processor configured to: determine a modeled rack force of the vehicle, determine a normal force factor of the vehicle, determine a vehicle speed factor of the vehicle, determine an adjusted rack force based on a product of the modeled rack force, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor, determine a lateral slip angle of the vehicle, determine a coefficient of friction estimation based on the adjusted rack force and the lateral slip angle, and control the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

2. The system of claim 1, wherein the electronic processor is configured to determine the modeled rack force by determining a gear ratio of a motor in the vehicle, determining an inertia of a rotor of the motor, determining an acceleration of the rotor, determining a motor torque of the motor, determining a torsion bar torque of a torsion bar, determining a torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, and determining a friction torque of the motor.

3. The system of claim 2, wherein the electronic processor is further configured to determine the modeled rack force by determining a first product of the inertia of the rotor and the acceleration of the rotor, determining a second product of the torsion bar torque and torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, determining a first sum of the motor torque, the second product, and the friction torque, determining a first difference between the first product and the first sum, and determining a third product of the gear ratio and the first difference.

4. The system of claim 1, wherein the electronic processor is configured to determine the coefficient of friction estimation using a look-up table (LUT).

5. The system of claim 1, wherein the electronic processor is further configured to determine a type of driving surface of the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

6. The system of claim 5, wherein the electronic processor is configured to determine whether the type of driving surface is at least one selected from the group consisting of ice, snow, gravel, wet paved road, and dry paved road.

7. The system of claim 6, further comprising a user interface, wherein the electronic processor is further configured to provide, to the user interface, an indication of the type of driving surface.

8. The system of claim 1, wherein the electronic processor is configured to control the vehicle by determining an optimal lateral slip for an upcoming turn, determining a target vehicle speed for achieving the optimal lateral slip, and controlling the vehicle according to the target vehicle speed.

9. The system of claim 1, wherein the electronic processor is further configured to transmit the coefficient of friction estimation to an autonomous vehicle fleet controller for controlling speeds of a fleet of autonomous vehicles.

10. A method for controlling a vehicle, the method comprising: measuring, with a set of vehicle sensors, a speed of the vehicle; outputting, with the set of vehicle sensors, a measured vehicle speed; measuring, with the set of vehicle sensors, a motor torque of a motor in the vehicle; outputting, with the set of vehicle sensors, a measured motor torque; determining, with an electronic processor, a modeled rack force of the vehicle; determining, with the electronic processor, a normal force factor of the vehicle; determining, with the electronic processor, a vehicle speed factor of the vehicle; determining, with the electronic processor, an adjusted rack force based on a product of the modeled rack force, the normal force factor, and the vehicle speed factor; determining, with the electronic processor, a lateral slip angle of the vehicle; determining, with the electronic processor, a coefficient of friction estimation based on the adjusted rack force and the lateral slip angle; and controlling, with the electronic processor, the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein determining, with the electronic processor, the modeled rack force includes determining a gear ratio of a motor in the vehicle, determining an inertia of a rotor of the motor, determining an acceleration of the rotor, determining a motor torque of the motor, determining a torsion bar torque of a torsion bar, determining a torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, and determining a friction torque of the motor.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein determining, with the electronic processor, the modeled rack

force further includes determining a first product of the inertia of the rotor and the acceleration of the rotor, determining a second product of the torsion bar torque and torsion bar torque to motor torque ratio, determining a first sum of the motor torque, the second product, and the friction torque, determining a first difference between the first product and the first sum, and determining a third product of the gear ratio and the first difference.

13. The method of claim 10, wherein determining, with the electronic processor, the coefficient of friction estimation includes using a look-up table (LUT).

14. The method of claim 10, further comprising determining, with the electronic processor, a type of driving surface of the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation.

15. The method of claim 14, determining, with the electronic processor, the type of driving surface of the vehicle based on the coefficient of friction estimation includes determining whether the type of driving surface is at least one selected from the group consisting of ice, snow, gravel, wet paved road, and dry paved road.

16. The method of claim 15, further comprising providing, with the electronic processor, an indication to a user interface, the indication indicative of the type of driving surface.

17. The method of claim 10, wherein controlling the vehicle includes determining an optimal lateral slip for an upcoming turn, determining a target vehicle speed for achieving the optimal lateral slip, and controlling the vehicle according to the target vehicle speed.

18. The method of claim 10, further comprising transmitting, with the electronic processor, the coefficient of friction estimation to an autonomous vehicle fleet controller for controlling speeds of a fleet of autonomous vehicles.
